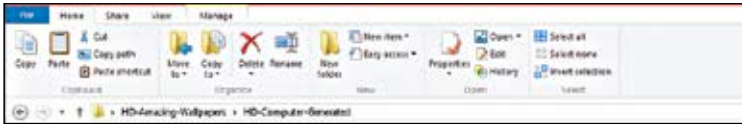


side in the 'Clipboard' section. There's an immensely helpful button named Copy path which is enabled only when at least one file is selected in the main window. Clicking it will copy the path of the selected file(s) and folder(s) to the clipboard. That's one useful function to supply the file name to any program or to help a friend over chat (e.g. when you need to tell them the location of a file to edit). You can sidestep the 'browse' button now and just paste the file path in the file-name box wherever available. Though we're accustomed to right-clicking files and folders to copy and paste them, two more buttons named Move to and Copy to are also present on the home tab. Delete and Rename have their own buttons too. These are in the 'Organize' section of the tab.

In the 'New' section we have three buttons: New folder, New item and Easy access. The New folder button is self-explanatory and exists in Windows 7 as well. The New item button will show you all the options you get



Home tab of Windows 8 File Explorer - The parent-folder button has returned on the address bar

in the 'New' section of a right-click in the main window (Shortcut, Text Document, Compressed Folder etc.). The easy access button allows you to pin an item to the start screen, include the selection in a library, add to favorites or map as a drive. Don't get excited though – the Map as a drive option doesn't let you map a local folder as a drive letter – you can only map a network folder as a drive. For remote files, three more options: 'Always available offline', 'Sync' and 'Work offline' are given.

Next is the 'Open' section with a Properties button. The default action is just what you guess – open the selected file(s) and/or folder(s) properties. However, clicking the triangle on the button opens up another option which lets you remove properties from a file. Clicking the Open button does what double-clicking the file would do – open it with the default app. However you can use it to do the 'Open with...' task as well. The Edit button is mostly disabled except in case you've selected a file which Windows 8 knows will be editable by a particular app, e.g. it would open Paint for an image. The most interesting inclusion is the History feature which we'll talk about at length later on.